

Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure

Owner: People Operations | Version: 3.0-rag | Effective date: 2026-04-20

Document type	Synthetic policy manual
Use case	RAG training, retrieval benchmarking, QA evaluation
Chunking guidance	Use one chunk per section and preserve section IDs

1. Purpose and Scope

Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure describes the formal policy requirements and operating procedures used by Northstar Analytics Ltd.. It is written as a synthetic but realistic document for training retrieval, summarization, and question-answering systems.

This document applies to all employees, interns, temporary workers, and approved contractors unless a section explicitly states otherwise.

Managers are responsible for enforcing this policy consistently and for escalating unusual cases to the document owner.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Employees must read, understand, and follow the policy requirements relevant to their role.

Managers must document exceptions in writing and retain approvals in the designated system of record.

The document owner reviews this policy at least annually and whenever business, legal, or technical requirements materially change.

3. Informal Resolution

The section on informal resolution defines the standard rule, the approval path, and the records that must be retained.

Requests related to informal resolution should be submitted through the official workflow rather than handled informally through chat or email alone.

When a manager grants an exception for informal resolution, the exception must include the reason, the duration, and any compensating controls.

Records related to informal resolution must be stored in the designated repository with a clear owner and retention period.

Metrics related to informal resolution should be reviewed periodically to identify recurring issues and opportunities for improvement.

4. Formal Investigation

The section on formal investigation defines the standard rule, the approval path, and the records that must be retained.

Requests related to formal investigation should be submitted through the official workflow rather than handled informally through chat or email alone.

When a manager grants an exception for formal investigation, the exception must include the reason, the duration, and any compensating controls.

Records related to formal investigation must be stored in the designated repository with a clear owner and retention period.

Metrics related to formal investigation should be reviewed periodically to identify recurring issues and opportunities for improvement.

5. Warnings

The section on warnings defines the standard rule, the approval path, and the records that must be retained.

Requests related to warnings should be submitted through the official workflow rather than handled informally through chat or email alone.

When a manager grants an exception for warnings, the exception must include the reason, the duration, and any compensating controls.

Formal warnings are normally issued in the sequence of verbal reminder, written warning, final written warning, and termination, although serious misconduct may justify acceleration.

Each warning must describe the conduct, the expected improvement, the review date, and the consequences of further breaches.

6. Appeals

The section on appeals defines the standard rule, the approval path, and the records that must be retained.

Requests related to appeals should be submitted through the official workflow rather than handled informally through chat or email alone.

When a manager grants an exception for appeals, the exception must include the reason, the duration, and any compensating controls.

Employees may submit a written appeal within 5 business days of receiving a formal disciplinary outcome.

Appeals should be reviewed by a manager or HR representative not directly involved in the original decision.

7. Record Retention

The section on record retention defines the standard rule, the approval path, and the records that must be retained.

Requests related to record retention should be submitted through the official workflow rather than handled informally through chat or email alone.

When a manager grants an exception for record retention, the exception must include the reason, the duration, and any compensating controls.

Records related to record retention must be stored in the designated repository with a clear owner and retention period.

Metrics related to record retention should be reviewed periodically to identify recurring issues and opportunities for improvement.

8. Exceptions and Escalations

Exceptions must be rare, time-bound, and approved by the designated authority named in the relevant section.

All exceptions must be logged with the approver, rationale, expiration date, and any required follow-up actions.

9. Document Control

Document owner: Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure owner

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Review frequency: annual or upon material change